CAPITOL REEF WITH CHSS



By Catarina Lindberg



CAPITOL REEF FIELD STATION

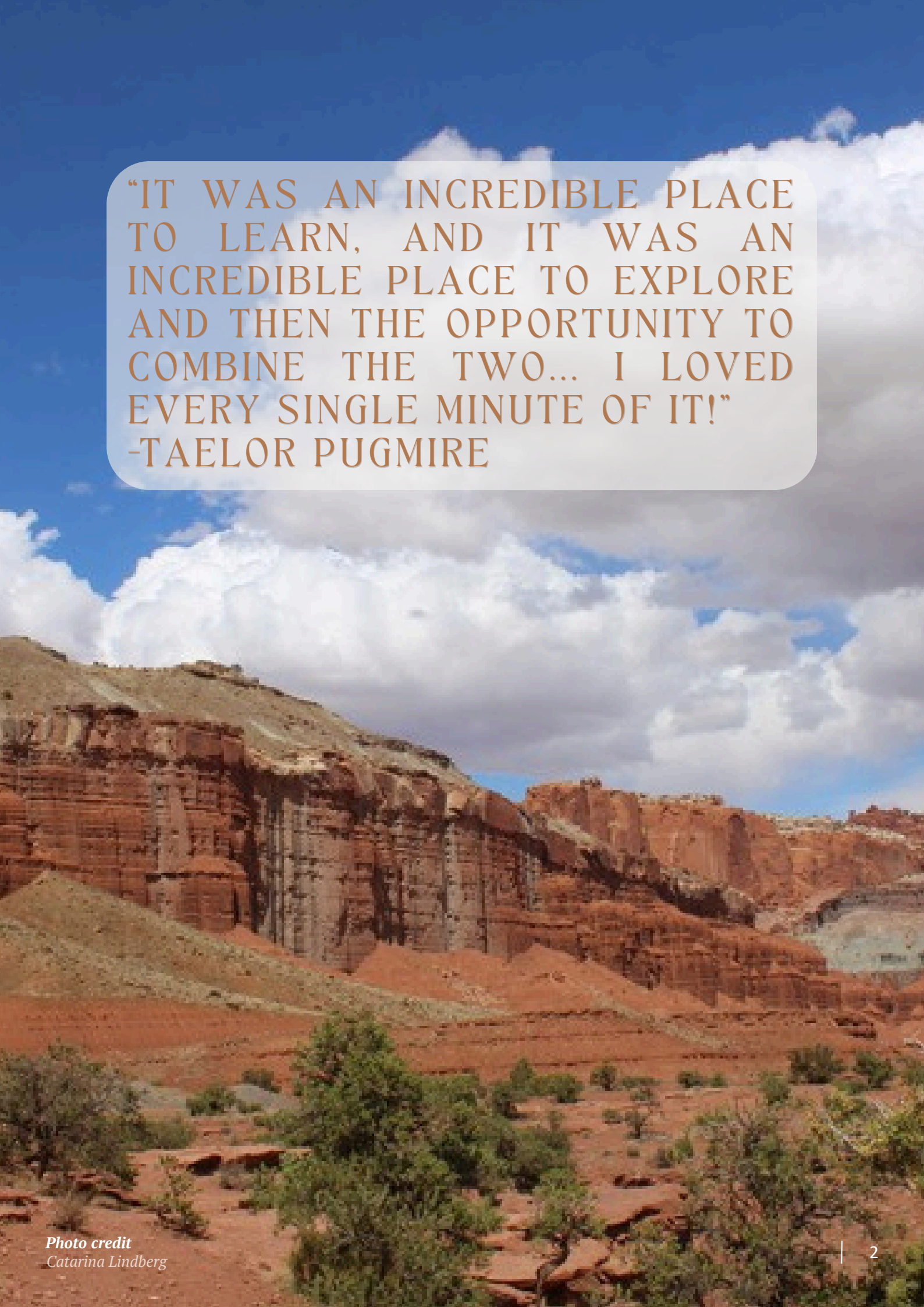
The field station at Capitol Reef was comfortable and focused on sustainability. The buildings were designed to not require any air conditioning, and keep cool. She said she was comfortable the whole trip.

THE CAPITOL REEF PUBLIC RELATIONS AND TOURISM CLASS EXPERIENCE

Taelor Pugmire decided to enroll in a College of Humanities and Social Sciences class at Capitol Reef Field Station to learn about public relations tourism. The class included a four day trip to Capitol Reef to explore and learn hands on how to plan a public relations tour trip. She had a wonderful experience.



The field manager taught the class about water conservation, and showed them how their water pump works. The water is sourced from the nearby Pleasant Creek river, and is pumped through a system to purify for use. The field manager also challenged the class to compete with other classes for lowest weight in garbage and lowest water usage. The Capitol Reef Field Station was built with minimal environmental impact. It is completely off grid powered by solar panels. The land was built on a bluff where the land was already impacted by the Sleeping Rainbow Ranch from the 1970's. There was even garbage from



"IT WAS AN INCREDIBLE PLACE TO LEARN, AND IT WAS AN INCREDIBLE PLACE TO EXPLORE AND THEN THE OPPORTUNITY TO COMBINE THE TWO... I LOVED EVERY SINGLE MINUTE OF IT!"
-TAELOR PUGMIRE

Photo credit
Catarina Lindberg

pioneers on property that was considered protected artifacts. The field manager took the class on a hike down pleasant creek where you can see hieroglyphs and dip in the river. The professor organized the trip as an example of what a public relations press tour would be like.

> "I'M MORE OF A VISUAL LEARNER, MORE OF AN ACTIVE LEARNER, AND SO TO BE ABLE TO TAKE THIS COURSE AND PUT IT INTO ACTION WHILE AT CRFS... REALLY HELPED ME LEARN."
> -TAELOR PUGMIRE

Then she reflected afterwards and created her own press tour trip. Professor Hanson created a fantastic and entertaining itinerary. The first stop was to the Circle Cliff Ranch to meet alpacas and hear from the business owner on how she markets and promotes her business. The class got to feed and interact with the alpacas as well.

The class got to learn how to make sourdough from the field manager in a baking class, and go on multiple hikes. She went on a hike to Hickman Bridge and Cassidy Arch. She also went with the class to see the visitors center, where there was an informational video.

She also connected with new people she'd never met before, creating new friendships. The group worked together daily to cook food in shifts and as a team, cleaned together, and did activities together. This brought them a sense of friendship from simple tasks. The class also was divided into two groups for a final project.

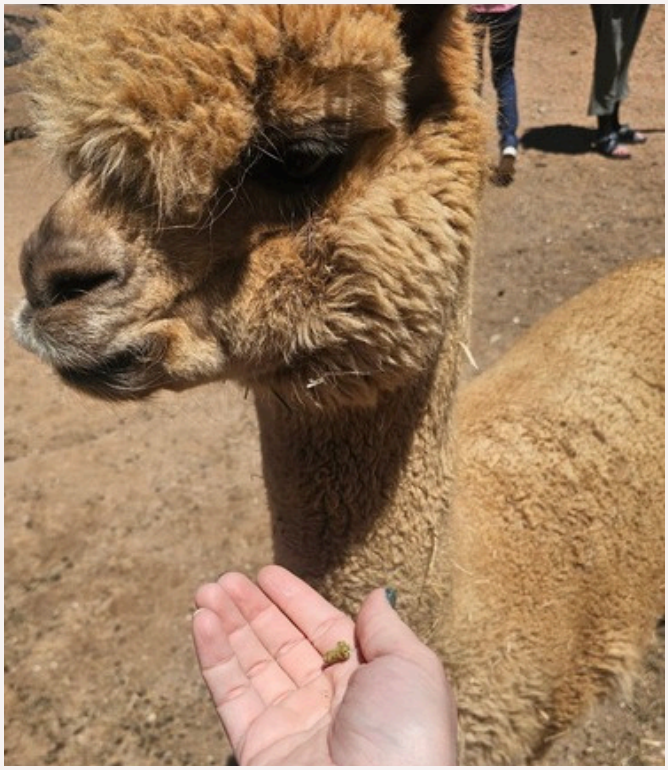


The final project was a public relations campaign presentation at the end of the trip. She and her group had to come up with a strategic communication plan to reduce the impact of the flood of visitors from the Might 5 campaign that Visit Utah did a few years ago. After their promotional campaign, the parks in Utah experience high traffic and high impact on the environment, and the project was to come up with a solution.

Her and her team came up with a few different options for their plan, a commercial to emphasize the Leave No Trace principles, and an educational plan for visitors from the park rangers on those principles.

Pugmire expressed how attending in person at CRFS to learn hands-on made her experience in the class better, and that she would highly recommend anyone take a class at CRFS.





She is a business owner doing travel advising, and she feels that learning about public relations in travel and tourism did help her in a real life application. She took many of the principles learned in the class and from her experience into her career. Taking the class, she feels that she had a once in a lifetime experience learning about a topic that impacted her career.

"THIS CLASS DEFINITELY HELPED ME GET CLOSER TO WHERE I WANT TO BE IN THE GOALS I WANT FOR MY CAREER AND LIFE."
-TAELOR PUGMIRE

Attending a class with CHSS to Capitol Reef Field Station was one of her favorite memories at Utah Valley University, and she recommends every student try it once.

Visit uvu.edu/crfs to learn more.

